



Vaibhav Marathe emerges fastest



Goa's Vaibhav Marathe (**above, right**) claimed top honours at the Chikmagalur Gravel Fest 2025, the opening round of the JK Tyre FMSCI Indian National Autocross Championship (INAC) 2025. The event was held at Survey 85 on Sangnipura Road in Chikmagalur.

Representing JK Tyre, Marathe edged out a stiff challenge from teammate Syed Salman to win the INAC 1 Unrestricted Class with a timing of 02:57.876. Salman clocked 02:59.687 to finish second, while Aeman took third place with a timing of 03:01.786.

The Chikmagalur round also served as the qualifier for this year's INAC.

Salman bounced back later in the day to win the INAC 1 2000cc class, recording a time of 02:59.169. Chetan Shivram and Aeman followed him home in second and third, respectively.

In the INAC 2 1650cc category, Ashad Pasha secured first place, with Aeman and Salman rounding off the podium. Salman then dominated the INAC 2 1450cc and 1100cc classes, taking top spot in both.

The INAC 2 800cc class was won by Azveer.

In other results, Zeeshan Mohammed clinched the INAC 3 category, while Shameena CP topped the Women's class with a timing of 03:41.004.

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SPORTOON



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Tickets for the Neeraj Chopra Classic 2025, a premier javelin throw

event set to take place on May 24 at the Sree Kanteerava Stadium in Bengaluru, are now live.

Fans can book tickets via the District by Zomato website or app, with prices ranging from Rs 199 to Rs 44,999.

The event will begin at 6:30 PM IST, with gates opening at 5 PM IST.

The meet will feature some of the world's top javelin throwers, headlined by Olympic champion Neeraj Chopra. Fellow Indians Kishore Jena, Sachin Yadav, Rohit Yadav and Sahil Silwal are also set to compete.

TEAM SPORTSTAR

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Formidables will represent India at the upcoming Bridge World

Championship in Denmark this August, having retained its team title at the 8th All India Shree Cement Bridge Championship. The champion side — Rajeshwar Tewari, Sumit Mukherjee, Kaustabh Nandi, Sagnik Roy and Sayantan Kushari — convincingly beat Mavericks 159-97 in the final. They took home a winner's prize of Rs 1.2 lakh.

In the semifinals, Formidables overcame Team Monica Jajoo 102-70, while Mavericks edged past Rampage 79-65. Rampage later clinched third place.

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